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WELFARE, HEALTH AND SAFETY POLICY

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1. Scope and responsibility

This policy covers the health, safety and welfare of students in our care, and of anyone acting for us. As a sole trader with no employees, we are not required to hold a written health and safety policy under the Health and Safety at Work Act, which applies that duty to organisations with five or more employees. We hold one because our students sleep in other people's homes, and because AEGIS requires us to demonstrate compliance with Health and Safety Executive requirements.

Overall responsibility rests with Yating Yang, Proprietor.

2. Accommodation — checks before any placement

No student is placed in any household, including the Guardian's own home, until an in-person assessment visit has been completed, health and safety checks carried out, a written risk assessment made, and the accommodation judged suitable. Comprehensive notes are kept in the Homestay File. The checklist at Schedule 2 of the Homestay Agreement is used for this purpose.

2.1 Minimum health and safety requirements

Requirement	Standard
Smoke alarms	At least one on every storey, tested at each visit
Carbon monoxide alarm	In any room containing a gas, liquid or solid fuel burning appliance
Gas safety	Annual check by a Gas Safe registered engineer; certificate copy held by us
Electrical safety	Sockets and light fittings secure and not overloaded; appliances used by the student safe
Fire escape	Evacuation routes discussed with the student; keys to locked doors or windows locatable
Open fires	Fire guard in place whenever lit
Matches, lighters, medication, alcohol	Stored appropriately, with particular care where students are young
First aid kit	Plasters, sterile eye pad, triangular bandage, safety pins, wound dressing, disposable gloves, guidance leaflet
Food hygiene	Basic awareness when preparing meals for students
Fire extinguishers and blankets	Not required unless the property is a house in multiple occupation; if present, must be serviced

Overseas plug adaptors are a known fire risk. We advise students to buy UK chargers and tell host families to raise it if they see adaptors in use.

3. Accommodation suitability

Every student has a bedroom for their sole use, not shared with any other person, and students never share a bed. The room must be clean, in good repair, adequately heated and lit, with natural light, storage for clothes and a private space to study. Students have access to a bathroom with a lock and either a bath or shower, and to the communal rooms of the house. Students do not enter family members' bedrooms.

No more than three students are placed with the same household at any one time, counting students placed by any other organisation. Where a student under 16 is hosted, no student over 20 is hosted at the same time. Host families do not take other paying guests or operate a bed and breakfast while hosting our students.

4. Supervision

Students of any age are supervised and are never permitted to live independently. Following NSPCC advice, students aged 12 and under are not left home alone for a long period; students aged 16 and under are not left home alone overnight; and no student of any age is left alone if they are not comfortable with it.

5. Transport

Any vehicle used to transport a student must be taxed, roadworthy and comprehensively insured, and the insurer must be told that the vehicle will be used to transport international students, for which payment or expenses may be received. Seat belt law is followed, and children under 12 or under 135cm use an appropriate child or booster seat.

Where a licensed taxi firm is used, we obtain written confirmation from the company that its drivers hold enhanced DBS checks, because those drivers have direct and largely unsupervised contact with students.

6. Medical and health

We hold signed medical consent for every student, along with allergy, medication and condition details, and we make sure the host family is fully informed. Where regular medication is required, a formal record of administration is kept by whoever administers it. Where a condition requires specialist knowledge or equipment — asthma, diabetes or severe allergies among others — we ensure the host family is trained and comfortable before the student is placed.

In a medical emergency: 999 first, then the Guardian. We attend, produce the signed consent so treatment is not delayed, and contact the parents within one hour.

7. Accident book

We keep an accident book recording any recordable event involving a student, a host family member or anyone acting for us: what happened, when and where, who was involved, injuries, action taken, and follow-up. Entries are reviewed at the annual policy review to identify patterns.

8. Insurance

Professional indemnity	FUL11018TOPS Accredited Insurance (Europe) Limited
Public liability	FUL11018TOPS Accredited Insurance (Europe) Limited
Host family home insurance	Host families confirm they have told their insurer they are hosting international students
Host family motor insurance	Confirmed where the family transports students

8.1 What our insurance does not cover

Stated here so that it is stated consistently everywhere else:

- Students' personal belongings — laptops, phones, passports, instruments, cash. Parents are advised in the Parent Handbook to arrange their own cover
- Host families' homes, contents or personal liability — host families are responsible for their own insurance
- Damage caused by a student to a host family's property and school‘s property

9. Review

This policy is reviewed each August, and after any accident, incident or change in guidance. Homestay health and safety is re-checked at every annual visit and whenever the household changes.